

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Possessed of Riches'

Ārya-Hiraṇyavatī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 570 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དབུ་དང་ལྷ་པ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུན་གྱི་མཛུས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Possessed of Riches," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Hiraṇyavatī-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phags pa dbyig dang ldan pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a dhāraṇī text in which the Buddha, dwelling in the Tuṣita heaven among a vast assembly of bodhisattvas, exhorts the bodhisattva Supraṭiṣṭhita to receive and uphold this sacred dhāraṇī, emphasizing that any bodhisattva who fails to do so has never truly encountered the Tathāgatas of the three times. The text belongs to the genre of dhāraṇī literature, presenting a condensed sacred formula framed within a brief narrative setting that underscores the incalculable spiritual merit and protection the dhāraṇī confers. It is catalogued as Toh 570 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the broader collection of dhāraṇī and mantra texts preserved within the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

In the language of India: Ārya-Hiraṇyavatī-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Possessed of Riches."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Tuṣita (the Joyous Heaven) upon a flat white stone, together with many thousands of bodhisattvas — all of them having received a prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, and all of them being solely those with but one birth remaining.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva, the great being Legs-par-gnas (Supraṭiṣṭhita):

"Legs-par-gnas, whatever bodhisattva, great being, does not wish to receive this dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches' — that one has neither seen, nor heard, nor encountered the Tathāgatas of the past, the future, or the present. But whoever has seen, heard, and encountered the Tathāgatas in this way has attained the dhāraṇī. Why is that? Because, Legs-par-gnas, the bodhisattva, great being, does not grasp at the thought 'I have accumulated merit,' nor does he grasp at the thought 'I have done what is not merit, or what is virtuous, or what is non-virtuous.' Why is that? Because, Legs-par-gnas, the bodhisattva, great being, neither conceptualizes nor elaborates upon the dhāraṇī as something to be held. The bodhisattva, great being, who has

attained the dhāraṇī neither conceptualizes nor fully reifies the phenomena of the past, future, and present as things or as having defining characteristics. He neither conceptualizes them as conditioned nor as unconditioned, as going nor as not going, as dying or transmigrating nor as being born, as empty nor as not empty, as marked nor as unmarked, as aspiring nor as not aspiring, as arising nor as ceasing.

Legs-par-gnas, the bodhisattva, great being, who conducts himself through this way of the extremes is said to abide in primordial wisdom. When he abides in primordial wisdom, that is called nirvāṇa. And when he has attained nirvāṇa, he then receives, perfectly masters, and holds this dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches' — and its meaning and syllables will never be exhausted. He is also one whose moral discipline is unexamined, possessing the moral discipline of truth and the moral discipline of complete purity. He is one whose Dharma is unexamined, possessing the Dharma of truth and the Dharma of complete purity. He does not rely upon others, but enters into his own Dharma. He has performed the supreme service to buddhas. He has entered the rite of the vidyā.

Legs-par-gnas, being thus, the bodhisattva, great being, is not attached, not bound, not released. Legs-par-gnas, when the bodhisattva, great being, is not attached, not bound, not released — at that time, through the other names of the vidyā-mantras of buddhas of the buddha lineage — of the Blessed Buddhas of the past, the future, and the present — and through the bases of their secret mantras, he attains the dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches.'

Thus: Kuṭi kuṭi, kucāla, elā imiriṭo, koṭhālā, ireri, imiriṇi.

Legs-par-gnas, these are the other names of the vidyā-mantras of the Blessed Buddhas of the past — and equally the other names of the vidyā-mantras of the Blessed Buddhas of the future and the present.

Legs-par-gnas, this dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches' is the mother of the Blessed Buddhas of the past, the future, and the present. Why is that? Because it does not abide in the meaning of the past, nor does it abide in the meaning of the future or the present.

Legs-par-gnas —"

Any great bodhisattva who holds this dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches' has made offerings and rendered homage to countless Blessed Buddhas. Those countless Blessed Buddhas have proclaimed it and caused it to be thoroughly

understood. Those countless Blessed Buddhas have prophesied that holder's attainment of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Legs-par-gnas, one who holds this dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches' should know within themselves: "I have pleased the wisdom of countless Blessed Buddhas in just this way — I have rendered them homage, I have made them offerings, and I have generated immeasurable merit."

Whatever person with whatever intention holds this dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches,' the following will come to abide near them: wisdom for one who desires wisdom, dhāraṇī for one who desires dhāraṇī, wealth for one who desires wealth, and learning for one who desires learning.

The ritual for this is as follows: on the waxing half of the month, at sunrise, one should cook rice gruel in milk and eat it. One should continuously hold in mind these vidyā-mantras of the buddhas, and the other names of the vidyā-mantras of the Blessed Buddhas. Nevertheless, by the power of the foundations of these secret mantras, all asuras, garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), kinnaras, great serpents, yakṣas, hungry ghosts, kumbhāṇḍas, flesh-eaters, humans, and non-humans dwelling in world-systems as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā will become delighted in heart toward that holder. They will not create obstacles. They will always completely protect that person.

The great bodhisattvas Ga-bzang, Yangs-pa-chen-po, Vajrapāṇi, Yongs-su-dga'-ldan, one who dwells on solitary mountains, and one who dwells on snow mountains — all of these will also completely protect that person. Even the bodhisattvas dwelling up to Akaniṣṭha will, by the power of the dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches,' bless that person in fearful places and in wilderness, and grant them fearlessness.

The Blessed One, seated on a flat stone like white alabaster in Tuṣita, having spoken these words, the great bodhisattva Legs-par-gnas and those many thousands of bodhisattvas were filled with joy and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The noble dhāraṇī called 'Possessed of Riches' is complete.

From India —

Translator's Notes

- The name of the bodhisattva interlocutor, Legs-par-gnas, renders a Tibetan term meaning "Well-Abiding" or "Excellently Established," most likely corresponding to Sanskrit Supraṭiṣṭhita; it has been left transliterated rather than translated in the body since it functions as a proper name throughout.

The phrase rendered "way of the extremes" translates mtha' 'dis spyod pa, literally "conducting oneself through/by these extremes" — referring to the series of paired negations just enumerated (conditioned or unconditioned, empty or not empty, etc.). The sense is that the bodhisattva moves within the middle way that transcends all such extremes, which is why this conduct is equated with abiding in primordial wisdom.

The text ends mid-address ("Legs-par-gnas —"), suggesting the passage as supplied is incomplete and continues beyond what was provided.

- The passage breaks off mid-colophon with "From India —" which is the standard opening of the Tibetan canonical colophon recording the translation history; the source text ends here and the remainder is not supplied.

The names Ga-bzang, Yangs-pa-chen-po, Yongs-su-dga'-Idan, "one who dwells on solitary mountains," and "one who dwells on snow mountains" are Tibetan renderings of bodhisattva names or epithets; in the absence of an identified Sanskrit source for these specific forms in this text, they are rendered as they stand rather than back-reconstructed, since mistaken Sanskrit reconstruction would be more misleading than faithful transliteration.

"Kumbhāṇḍas" (Tib. grul bum) are a class of spirits described in Indian Buddhist cosmology, sometimes depicted as gourd-shaped beings; they are left in Sanskrit as a technical term without a transparent English equivalent.

The ritual prescription to eat rice gruel cooked in milk at sunrise on the waxing moon is a standard sādhana-type instruction found in dhāraṇī literature and is rendered literally.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.